A Strategic Anchor for the Space Coast and a Long-Term Value Driver for New Smyrna Beach and Volusia County

The Florida Space Innovation Center (FSIC) is a regional platform designed to ensure that the growth of Florida's space economy directly benefits the people who live and work in Volusia County. By coordinating workforce training, research partnerships, business attraction, and community programming, FSIC strengthens the region's economic foundation and expands access to high-skill, high-wage career pathways. It accelerates development, attracts new employers, and brings in substantial external investment—creating long-term economic stability and opportunity.

The 25-year analysis shows that FSIC delivers transformational economic value for Florida, generating **$10.2–$12.4 billion in economic output**, **74,500–79,500 job-years**, and **$1.35–$1.55 billion in new wages** across aerospace, engineering, advanced manufacturing, and technology fields. This growth drives **$690–$910 million in fiscal revenue for local and state governments** through increased property, sales, and tourism-related taxes. FSIC also accelerates regional development timelines and positions Florida to capture **$800 million to $1.56 billion in external federal, state, private, and philanthropic funding** tied to innovation, research, and workforce development. FSIC represents a rare, high-leverage investment that strengthens Florida's competitiveness in the global space economy while delivering sustained economic returns for decades.

What the Florida Space Innovation Center (FSIC) Is

The Florida Space Innovation Center (FSIC) is a four-engine regional initiative designed to strengthen the Space Coast's talent pipeline, innovation capacity, business readiness, and civic identity. It is built to be a signature anchor for Southeast Volusia County — one that brings daily activity, long-term value, and a clear identity rooted in education, innovation, and community.

The Four-Engine Model

FSIC operates through a coordinated, phased model:

Talent Engine

- Micro-credential academies
- Dual-enrollment STEM pathways
- Industry-embedded learning
- Teacher upskilling
- Regional Talent Marketplace

Transform individuals into skilled talent

Innovation Engine

- Challenge labs with Industry problems
- Rapid prototyping studio
- Student + industry hackathons
- Applied research partnerships

Transform knowledge into innovation

Market Engine

- Supplier readiness bootcamps
- SBIR/STTR navigation
- Startup acceleration
- Venture funding
- Contract matchmaking

Transform opportunity into market success

Civic Engine

- Community STEM nights
- Arts + space integration
- Public exhibitions
- Transparent governance
- Innovation Campus

Transform trust into civic legitimacy

Talent Engine – Drives hands-on learning, employer-aligned training, and community programs. Immediate activation and visible workforce outcomes.

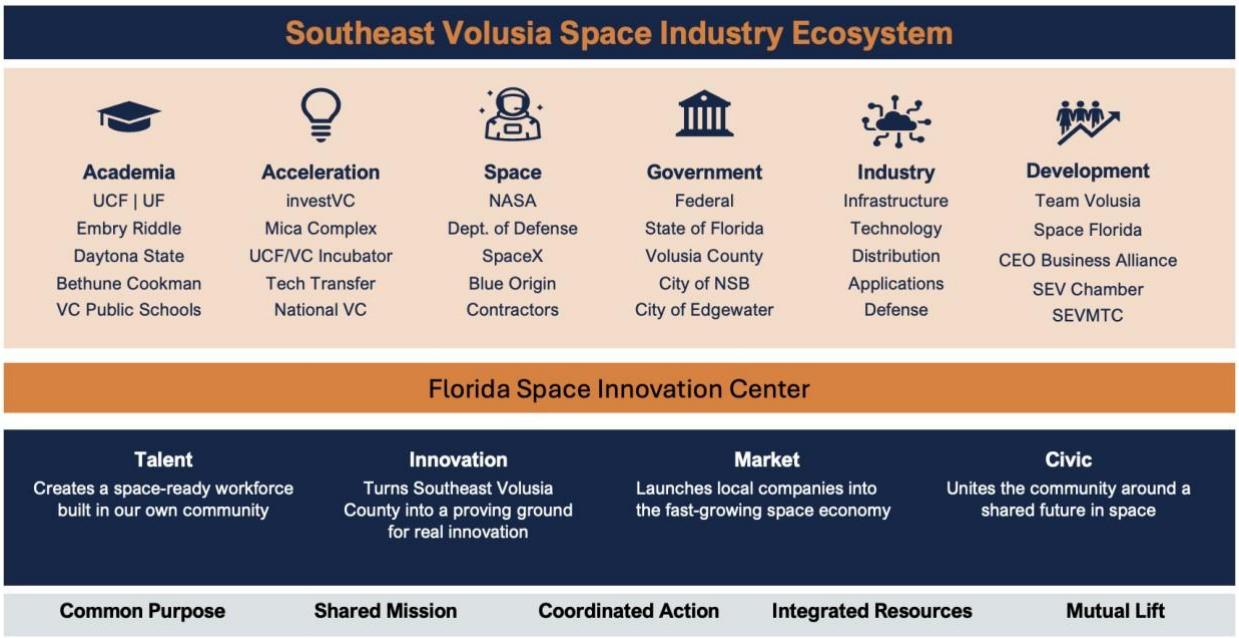
Innovation Engine – Powers challenge labs, prototyping, applied research, and university partnerships. Makes SE Volusia a place where innovation is built.

Market Engine – Accelerates supplier readiness, SBIR/STTR support, startups, and venture pathways. Strengthens the regional business ecosystem.

Civic Engine – Engages the community through STEM nights, exhibitions, and arts-and-space programming. Builds identity, trust, and a sense of place.

Guiding Principles

The Florida Space Innovation Center's partner strategy is intentionally partner-first, gap-filling, and coalition-driven. FSIC positions itself as a neutral convener that strengthens—not competes with—existing institutions by aligning talent, industry needs, and community priorities. The strategy starts small, delivers visible early wins, and scales only when partners signal readiness. Every partnership is structured for low operational burden, high shared value, and clear governance, ensuring FSIC becomes a trusted regional hub that accelerates innovation, workforce pathways, and long-term economic impact across the Space Coast. This ensures FSIC strengthens — not competes with — existing institutions



Strategic Value to Volusia County and New Smyrna Beach

FSIC enhances Deering Park and the county's development in several ways:

- **Year-Round Activation & Economic Activity** - Daily foot traffic from students, educators, employers, families, and events drives demand for services, supports small businesses, and stimulates economic activity across the county.
- **A Countywide Identity Anchor** - FSIC gives Volusia County a signature institution tied directly to the space and advanced-technology economy — a differentiator that elevates the county's profile across the Space Coast and the state.

- **Talent Attraction, Retention & Mobility** - Integrated school and community programming strengthen the county's talent pipeline, attract families seeking high-quality education, and helps retain young people who want career pathways close to home.
- **Employer Attraction & Higher-Wage Job Growth** - FSIC enhances the county's market story, making Volusia County more competitive for space and technology employers. It supports the creation of higher-wage jobs and broadens the county's economic base.
- **Alignment With Funding** - FSIC is positioned for significant external investment through:
  - National Science Foundation (NSF) Engines
  - Build Back Better style regional grants
  - State workforce and economic development funding
  - Space Florida financing and lease-back tools

This reduces risk and brings outside dollars into Volusia County.

Phased Deployment Aligned with Development Timing

FSIC launches with the Talent Engine, requiring minimal physical footprint while delivering immediate workforce and employer-support value. The Innovation, Market, and Civic Engines scale as partnerships deepen and countywide development continues. This sequencing ensures the Center grows in step with Volusia's economic priorities, infrastructure planning, and employer demand.

Long-Range Vision (2031–2040)

Conceptual

Beyond the master plan, FSIC evolves into a permanent, iconic institution anchored at Deering Park:

- **Multi-University Consortium** - Permanent university facilities, shared research labs, and joint academic programs.
- **Multi-Purpose Auditorium and a Performing Arts Center** - A Space Florida–financed convening hub that doubles as a regional performing arts center supported by the community.
- **Landmark Campus** - A visible architectural identity that positions Southeast Volusia County as the intellectual and cultural heart of the Space Coast.

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